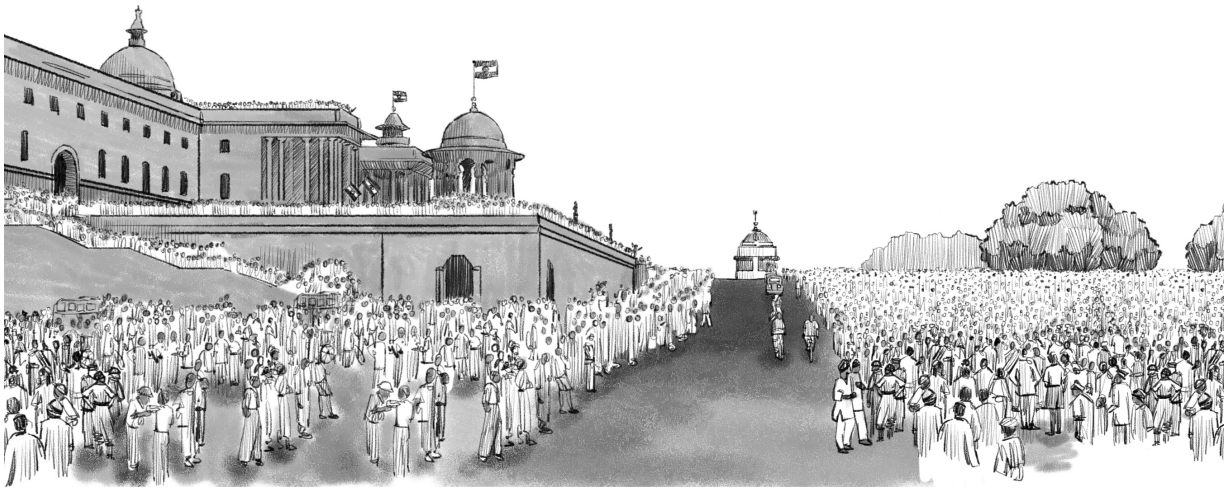
CHAPTER 11
The Pride of Modern India

In 1947, India became independent. British rule was over. There was a ceremony at Shah Jahan's Red Fort at Delhi. It was a time of great hope and pride for the people of India. The country was going to be a democracy with leaders that the people elected. The magnificent Taj Mahal was a symbol of the new country's pride. A prize-winning Indian poet had written of the Taj Mahal:

You knew, Emperor of India, Shah Jahan,
That life, youth, wealth, renown
All float away down the stream of time . . .
Yet still one solitary tear
Would hang on the cheek of time
In the form
Of this white and gleaming Taj Mahal.



The new Indian government continued efforts started by the British to care for famous landmarks. But the nation had many needs that had to come